

POLESTAR ADVISORY · SPOT REPORT

Strait of Hormuz Maritime Disruption

HIGH

LOCATION

Strait of Hormuz

REPORT DATE

27 Jun 2026 10:00

INCIDENT DATE

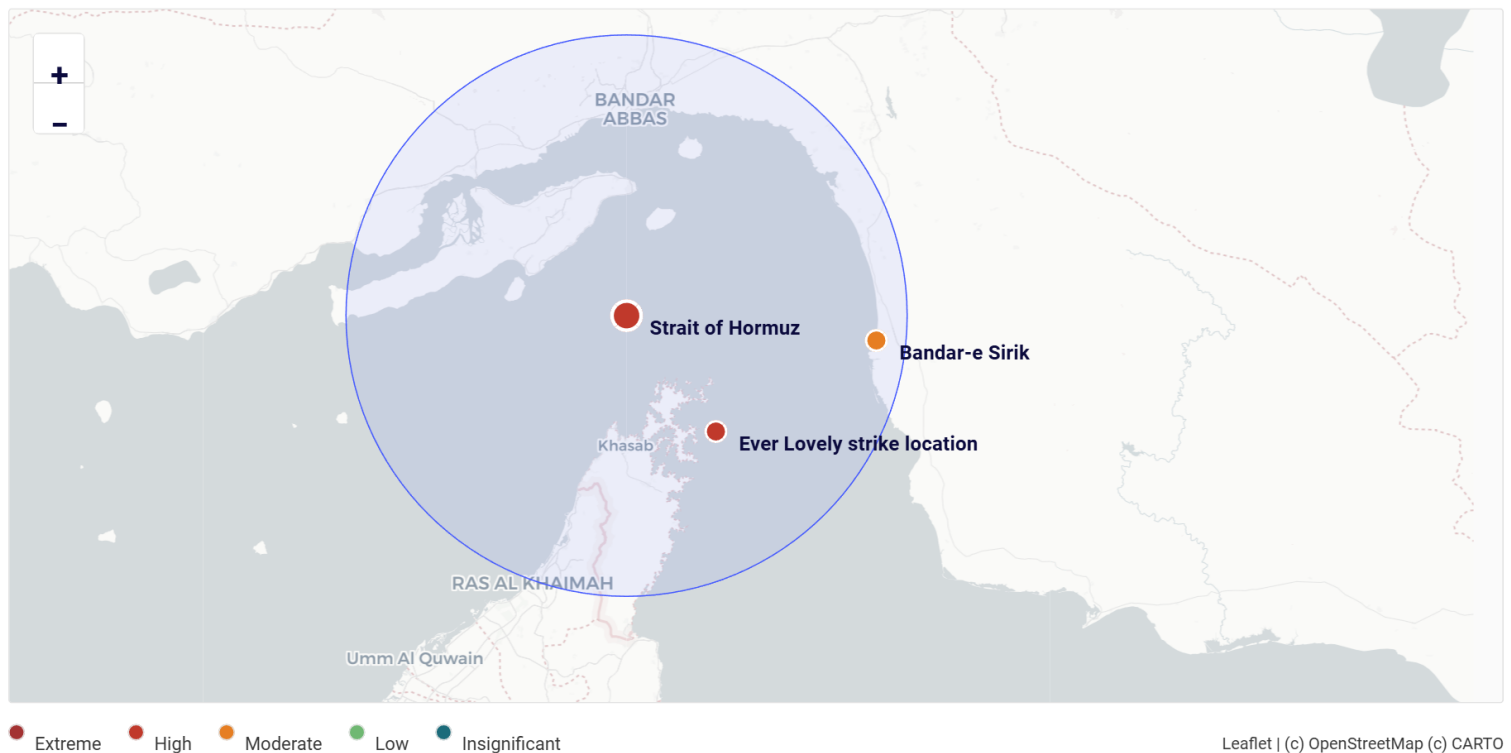
26 Jun 2026 17:30

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The Strait of Hormuz remains open but the operating environment has deteriorated following the strike on the Singapore flagged Ever Lovely and subsequent US retaliation against Iranian military infrastructure. The incident has not resulted in a full closure of the Strait, but it has interrupted the IMO evacuation framework, slowed tanker movement and increased uncertainty for vessels operating in or exiting the Gulf.

The immediate issue is not a complete stop in shipping. The issue is degraded transit confidence. Vessels are still moving, but operators, insurers, flag states and charterers are likely to reassess routing, crew risk and timing over the next 24 to 72 hours. Crude markets have not yet priced this as a major supply shock because tankers continue to move, but the position remains fragile.

INCIDENT MAP



INCIDENT DETAILS

On 25 June, the Singapore flagged container vessel Ever Lovely was struck by an unknown projectile or object while transiting near the Omani side of the Strait of Hormuz. The vessel sustained damage to the bridge area but remained seaworthy and completed its transit. All 21 crew were reported safe, with no Singaporeans on board.

The incident was followed on 26 June by US strikes against Iranian missile, drone and coastal radar sites. The US framed the action as retaliation for the attack on commercial shipping. The strike appears limited and calibrated rather than the start of a wider campaign, but it has increased the risk of further Iranian response or renewed disruption to commercial traffic.

Iran has continued to state that safe passage through the Strait requires coordination with Tehran. This matters because it creates uncertainty

over which routes are considered acceptable, who provides safety guarantees, and whether vessels using non Iranian approved routing could be exposed to further risk

IMAGERY



CURRENT SITUATION

The Strait of Hormuz is open, but traffic remains below normal and the security environment is unstable. Commercial shipping has continued to

move through the waterway, including crude tankers, but movements are cautious and uneven.

The IMO has paused its evacuation initiative following the attack. Before the pause, approximately 115 vessels and 2,500 seafarers had been moved through the Strait under the evacuation framework. More than 500 vessels reportedly still require evacuation or assisted movement, and the operation may take several weeks to complete once restarted.

The IMO is seeking renewed safety guarantees from relevant parties before restarting the process. Until that happens, operators remain exposed to uncertainty around route security, mine risk, vessel concentration, crew welfare and possible further military activity.

OPERATIONAL IMPACT

Shipping through Hormuz has slowed but has not stopped. Tanker transits reportedly fell to 13 on Friday, compared with 24 on Thursday and 27 on Wednesday. Overall ship traffic on 24 June was reported at 62 vessels, roughly half the level seen on the same day a year earlier. This indicates that traffic is moving, but the Strait has not normalised.

At least four tankers reportedly entered the Gulf for loading after the incident, including three major crude carriers. Several supertankers also continued to move Iranian oil, and one vessel reportedly exited the Strait carrying around two million barrels of crude. This is why the market did not treat the incident as an immediate supply break.

The disruption remains operationally significant. Delays are likely where vessels await updated advice from owners, insurers, flag states or charterers. Some operators may avoid movement until the IMO route position is clarified. War risk premiums, crew risk tolerance and charter party obligations may also influence vessel decisions over the next 72 hours.

The highest exposure remains crude, LNG, LPG, fertiliser and container shipping linked to Gulf origin supply. Fertiliser and LPG remain particularly exposed because there are fewer easy substitutes if Gulf flows become unreliable. Container movements are also exposed where vessels are already inside the Gulf and need to exit through Hormuz.

POLESTAR VIEW

The Strait of Hormuz remains open, but it is no longer operating in a normal risk environment. The key issue is degraded confidence rather than full closure. Vessels are still moving, but the attack on Ever Lovely, the pause to the IMO evacuation framework and the subsequent US retaliation have increased uncertainty for owners, insurers, charterers and crews.

The US response appears calibrated. It was visible enough to answer the attack on commercial shipping, but limited enough to avoid signalling a wider campaign. There is no confirmed evidence that the timing was designed to reduce market impact, although a Friday strike does increase the risk of delayed market reaction if further incidents occur over the weekend.

Current crude prices are not fully reflecting the operational risk. Brent and WTI moved lower because tankers continued to transit and Gulf loading activity resumed. This should not be read as normalisation. If traffic slows further, the IMO evacuation remains paused, or Iran responds, fuel and shipping costs could reprice quickly.

OUTLOOK (24–72H)

The most likely scenario is continued reduced transit through Hormuz rather than full closure. Vessel traffic is expected to remain cautious while operators wait for clarity on the IMO evacuation restart, Iranian route requirements and any further US or Iranian activity.

Fuel markets are currently softer than the operational picture. Brent fell to around USD 71.99 per barrel on 26 June and WTI to around USD 69.23, reflecting continued tanker movement, resumed loading activity and lower immediate supply fears. Jet fuel has also eased, with the global average falling to around USD 119.17 per barrel. This should not be read as reduced maritime risk.

If vessel movement continues, crude and fuel prices may remain contained. If Iran responds, tanker transits fall further, or the IMO evacuation remains paused, markets could reprice quickly. The main risk is a Monday gap higher if further incidents occur over the weekend.

Retail fuel costs are unlikely to move immediately unless crude rises again. Jet fuel, shipping fuel and logistics costs are more exposed to short

term movement through insurance, delay, routing, uplift and charter costs

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Review all vessels, cargoes and suppliers with exposure to the Strait of Hormuz over the next 72 hours.
- Confirm whether any contracted vessels are inside the Gulf, awaiting exit, or scheduled to enter for loading.
- Monitor IMO, UKMTO, flag state, insurer and port authority updates for route changes or renewed evacuation guidance.
- Do not assume lower crude prices mean lower operational risk. Market prices are currently reflecting continued flow, not a normalised security environment.
- Review exposure to Gulf linked crude, LNG, LPG, fertiliser and containerised cargoes.
- Prepare for possible Monday price volatility if there is further US Iranian activity over the weekend.

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